'You have to swallow the pips too,' said the voice in my head *'You have to swallow the pips and the peel. You have to swallow all the evidence.'*

'Yes, of course,' I said.

I swallowed the pips and put some of the peel in my mouth.

'Don't eat it!' said the voice. *'There isn't time. Swallow it! Be quick! Swallow it!'*

I took a small knife from my pocket and cut the oranges into large chunks. I swallowed the pieces of oranges one after the other.

There were still three oranges on the table when I heard Pongo outside. I stopped. My stomach was nearly full.

'Be quick! Swallow them!' said the voice in my head.

I was lucky. Pongo and the other policeman had seen some carts at the dock gate. They went and talked to the drivers. This gave me a few more minutes.

I must swallow all the oranges, I thought. Only three left!

I swallowed the first one, and then the second one.

Suddenly the door began to open. I went through a great deal of struggle and finally managed to finish off the last piece of the last orange. Pongo and the other policeman walked in.

'This is the thief.' Pongo said. 'I caught him with his pockets full of oranges.'

- Why did the policemen arrive a little late to the cabin?
- What did the narrator do with the pips and peels?

Then Pongo looked at the table and at first, he could not figure out what had happened. 'Where are the oranges?'

'I can smell them,' said the other policeman.



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